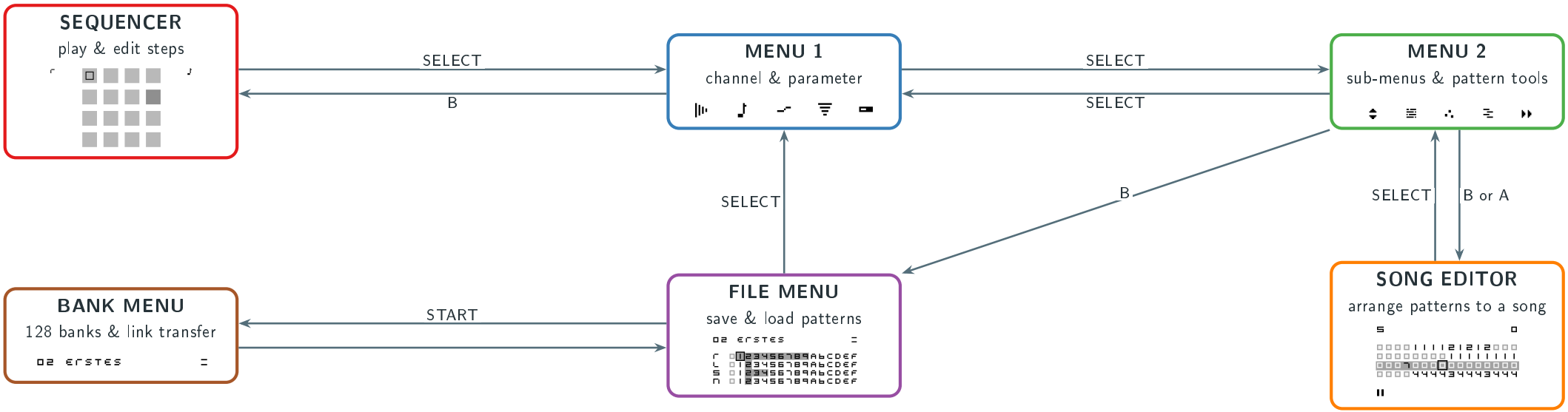
nanoloop 2 · cheatsheet

unofficial summary of the official 2.8 manual · GBA cart & Analogue Pocket built-in version

Notation: [B]+▲ = hold [B], tap D-pad up. All sound parameters are set *per step* – there are no instruments. Channel is shown top-left, edit parameter top-right.

WORKFLOW – modes & how to move between them



THE SEQUENCER

16 steps in a 4×4 grid; the playing step is darker.

▲▼◀▶ ..... move cursor
[B] ..... place note
[A] ..... cut note / paste on empty step
[B]+▲▼◀▶ ..... edit note (current parameter)
[A]+▲▼◀▶ ..... edit extra parameters
[START] ..... mono / chord mode (pitch param)
[R]+◀/▶ ..... meta step
[SELECT] ..... menu 1

Default parameter is pitch: [B]+▲▼ semitone, [B]+◀▶ octave.

Meta step: *[R]+◀/▶/▼ makes a step play only every 2nd or 4th pattern round.*

CHANNELS

[R] mono PWM/FM, arp chords, pitch env/LFO
[L] mono PWM/FM, same as R
[S] poly PWM/FM: real chords, stereo phasing, filter/mod env
[N] noise: filter + speed, arp on speed

R/L/S: filtered pulse wave (variable width) or FM (mod amount + mod freq).

Startup: *at the logo, pick colours – [START] pink/white, [SELECT] pink/black, ▲ grey/white.*

SYNC

S8 click every 2nd step (default; PO, Volca…)
S16 1 click per step
S24 3 clicks/step – for MIDI adaptor
SY1 clicks on left audio ch. (PO slave; not on GBA)

Mode is set in menu 2: [A]+▲▼. MIDI clock goes out via the link port (Pocket-to-MIDI cable).

CV sync: *in slave mode press [B]+[SELECT] – "c" under the tempo; 1 pulse per step.*

S16 auto-revert: *no clock for ~2 s → back to step 1.*

Start modes: *[B] = pattern-sync (song follows the running loop). [A] = manual/external: [START] starts at once and sends sync, [B]+[A] = slave.*

MENU 1 – channel & parameter

◀▶ select edit parameter · ▲▼ select channel · B back to sequencer
B/A + ▲▼◀▶, START ..... edit *all* notes at once
A + START ..... mute / unmute channel
R + START note value / bar view · R + ▲▼◀▶ randomise (repeat = wider range)
R + SELECT ..... new / legacy mode (n / L, saved)
SELECT ..... menu 2

PITCH / CHORD

B + ▲▼ semitone · B + ◀▶ octave · START chord mode on/off
B + START chord: relative (note + intervals) / absolute (4 notes)
A + ▲▼ chord interval · A + ◀▶ select chord step (top note = pause) · L arpeggio envelope on/off

Chords: arpeggio on R/L, polyphonic on S. N has no pitch – always arpeggio (on playback frequency).

VOLUME / ENVELOPE

B + ▲▼ ..... volume
B + ◀▶ ..... length
A + ▲▼ ..... envelope: D / AD / gate
A + ◀▶ ..... click / soft attack

D = decay only. AD = attack = decay. Gate = full level for the set length. Far right = infinite envelope. Click on R, soft attack on L, S, N.

BEND / LFO

B + ▲▼ ..... amplitude
B + ◀▶ ..... length / frequency
A + ▲▼ ..... envelope / LFO
A + ◀▶ ..... S only: pitch / filter

Acts on pitch (R,L,S) and filter cutoff / FM mod depth (S,N). Lower half = retriggered, upper = free-running.

WAVEFORM

B + ▲▼ ..... cutoff / FM modulation
B + ◀▶ ..... pulse width / mod freq
A + ▲ ..... FM (R,L,S) / GB noise (N)
A + ▼ ..... PWM / highpass noise (N)
A + ▶ ..... bandpass / metallic noise
A + ◀ ..... highpass / white noise

On N: B + ◀▶ = noise speed; L toggles GB noise 16/8-bit.

PAN / DELAY

B + ◀▶ ..... panning (S and N only)
B + ▲▼ ..... delay / delay + original

Editing delay for all notes from menu 1 hits only even steps – that is the swing control.

MENU 2 – sub-menus & pattern tools

B (or A) opens the selected sub-menu / function below
SELECT back to menu 1 · A + ▲▼ sync mode (S8 / S16 / S24 / SY1 – page 1)
Icon row above, in order: file, song, ping-pong, shift, tempo.

FILE MENU

128 banks × 15 slots per channel. Slot 0 is read-only (loads an empty pattern). The bank also carries the waveforms – switching banks can change the sound at once.

▲▼ select channel · ◀▶ select slot · START bank menu · SELECT back to menu 1

B + ▼	save pattern to slot	B + ▲	load pattern from slot
A + ▼	save all 4 (column)	A + ▲	load column
B + ◀▶	next slot + load	A + ◀▶	next column + load all
B + R + ▲	load pattern with tempo	A + B + ▲	load column on 1st step
A + B + ▼	delete slot	A + B + ◀▶	mute / unmute / solo

Lock: L + R locks saving ("X" shown), against accidental overwriting.
Bank menu: A + B + ▲ copy bank · A + B + ▼ paste bank · B + ▲▼ edit bank name
Transfer: A + B + ▲ send bank · A + B + ▼ receive bank · on error: SELECT cancels, A + B keeps the data.

SONG EDITOR

B + ▲▼ select pattern · B + ◀▶ copy value to next step
A + ▲ load patterns at cursor · A + ◀▶ turn page (15 pages)
R channel follows tempo · L channel follows pattern length
START start song at cursor · SELECT back to menu 2

Song is saved when you leave the editor – not if you power off inside it. Tempo is stored with each pattern.

PING-PONG

B + ◀ ..... on
START ..... random
B + ▶ ..... normal (off)

SHIFT

B + ▲▼ ..... length
B + ◀▶ ..... shift
A + ◀▶ ..... shift+delay
START copy pattern ·
A + B paste

TEMPO

B + ◀▶ ..... tempo
B + ▲▼ ... 1/x tempo (ch.)
START ..... start / master
A + B ..... stop / slave
A pause / step · B resume